

# How might we ...

(Hot tip: What is the problem space/opportunity your group found in the affinity diagrams that you want to investigate?)



WAVE

DESIGN THINKING

INTRO

REDESIGNING DESIGN

DESIGNING SOCIETY

How?

GETTING UNDER YOUR SKIN

3 SPACES OF INNOVATION

THE PROJECT & THE BRIEF

SMART TEAMS

THE INNOVATION ENVIRONMENT

BUILDING TO THINK

A MENTAL MATRIX

INTRO

ELEMENTS OF DESIGN THINKING

PREVAILING CONDITIONS

TOOLS

INTEGRATIVE THINKING

EMPA

INS

WHAT IS A PROTOTYPE?

TYPING ORGANIZATIONS

CRICOS 00026A



We recognise and pay respect to the Elders and communities – past, present, and emerging – of the lands that the University of Sydney's campuses stand on. For thousands of years they have shared and exchanged knowledges across innumerable generations for the benefit of all.



# Overview: Week 6

- Design Thinking concepts & theory
- Design Thinking methods & practice
- Wrap Up



## Weekly lecture attendance check

- In-person and online attendance, and recorded lecture views are monitored
- Students who attend or watch lecture recordings have a much better understanding of key concepts, and tutorial and assessment requirements
- No mark penalty but you will receive reminder emails about the importance of lectures



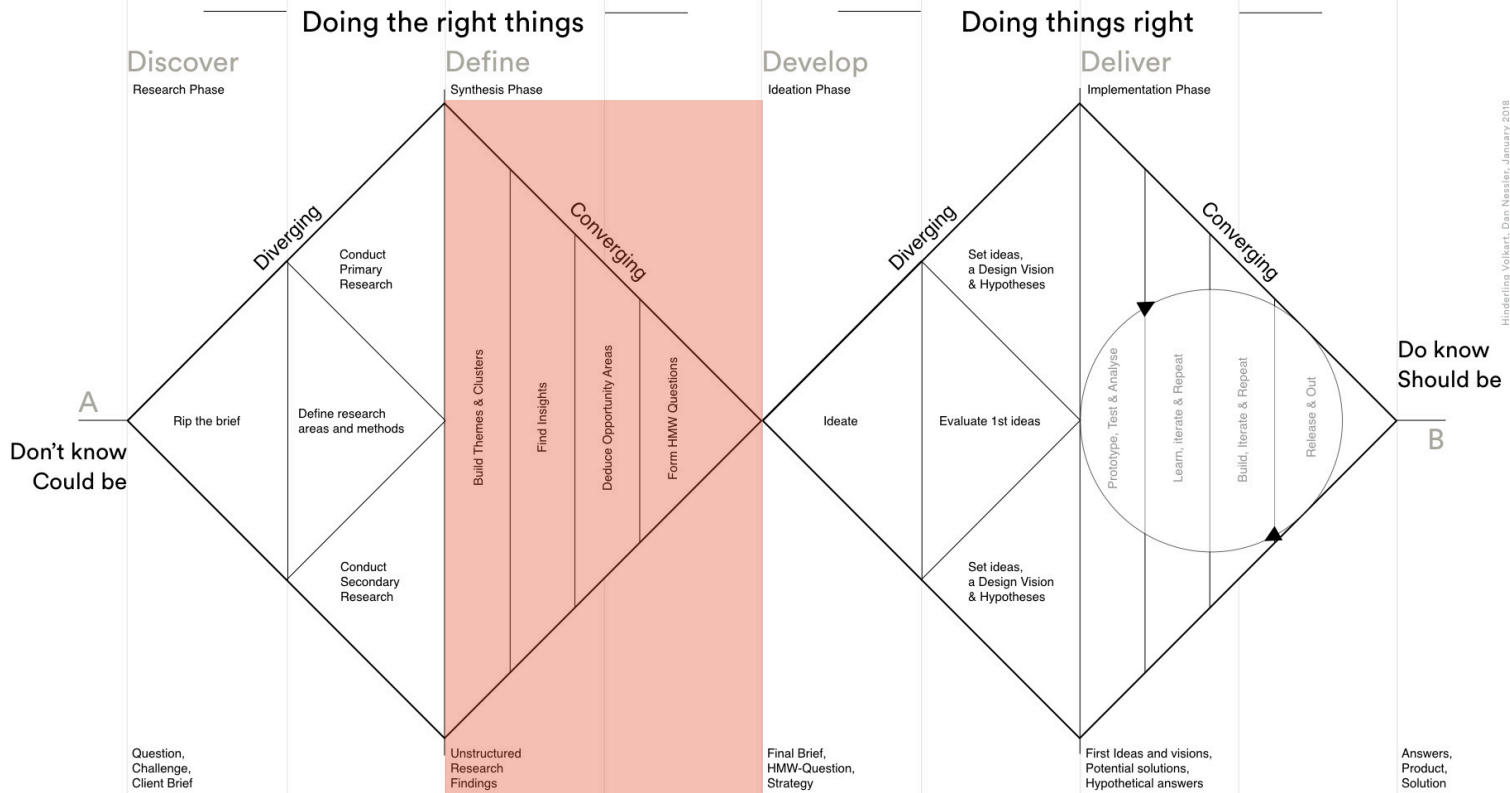
## Teacher Check-in



## Overview: Week 6

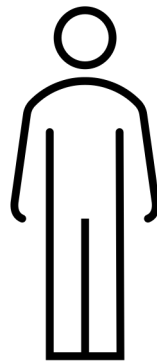
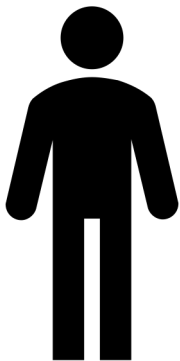
- **Design Thinking concepts & theory**
- **Design Thinking methods & practice**
- **Wrap Up**



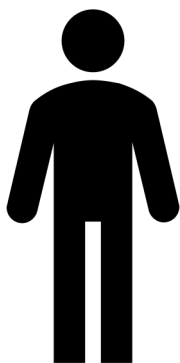


# Limitations of representation

**You will never be in the room with everyone you design for**



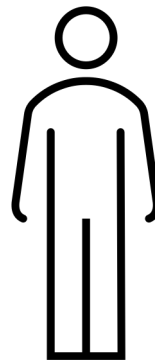
# Limitations of representation



The gap between your life and the life of  
the person you design for.  
It does not close.



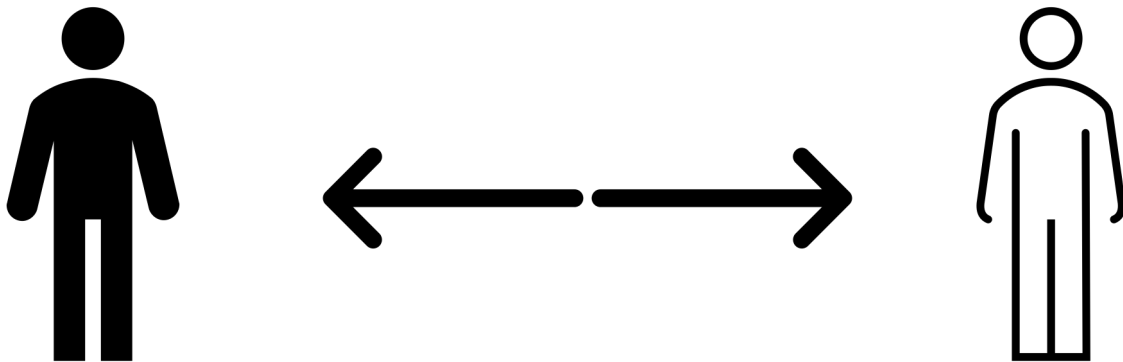
Distance



# Two conceptual moves

**1- Appreciate the distance.**

**2- Then reach across it, knowing the gap stays.**



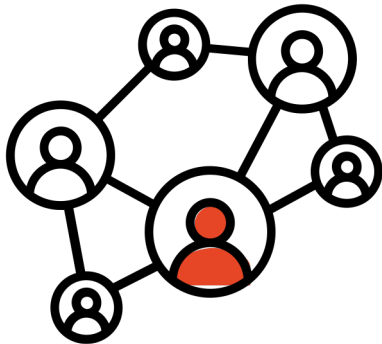
# 1- Appreciating a distance

- A single distance tells you almost nothing.
- Read it in the context of the life it runs through: who else has a claim, what else is going on, what the person is already carrying.



## 2- Three ways to reach

- **Be there.**



Stand beside someone. Stay long enough to be changed by what you find.

It takes time, which is the first thing we trade away.

## 2- Three ways to reach

- **Be there.**
- **Make a representation.**

You cannot fit a thousand users around a table.

A sketch, a prototype, a journey map, a persona.

Something that carries a little of the person into the room.

Your persona this afternoon is a representation.



## 2- Three ways to reach

- **Be there.**
- **Make a representation.**
- **Leave room.**



Some distances are too great for the first two. Stop reaching.

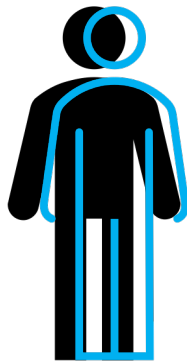
Build the thing open enough that their own lives can finish it.

The right reach is sometimes barely a reach at all.

# Guessing is cheaper than going

**A template does not know where its contents came from.**

The persona built from three days in the field and the persona built from a morning of guessing look identical on the slide.



# Faked reaches!

- The fifteen-minute interview that comes back sounding like a lifetime's friendship.
- The prototype handed over to be blessed, where the only answer you are ready to hear is yes.
- The session run to confirm what you already decided.



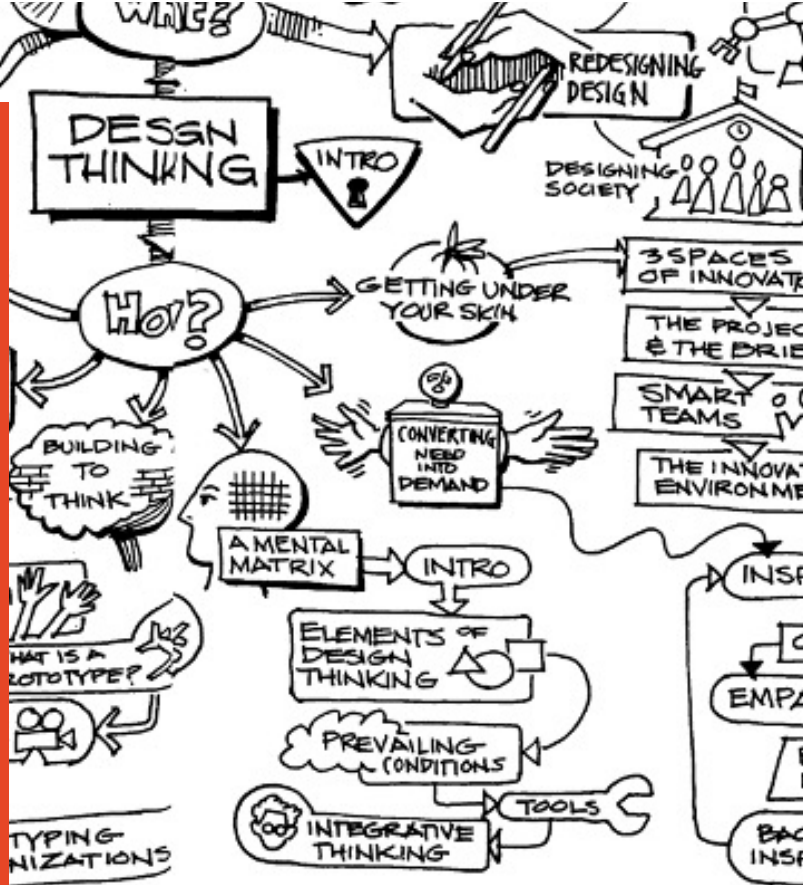
# How to tell?

- Nothing in it surprises you.
- If you cannot point to a moment, a sentence someone said, a thing you watched them do, the reach is not real.
- Build for the average and you have built for nobody, while the people at the edges, who are most people, go unreached.



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A person X needs to do Y

A person X needs to do Y



Who is person X?

How do we get to know person X?

How do we involve person X in the design process?

A person X needs to do Y



Who is person X?

How do we get to know person X?



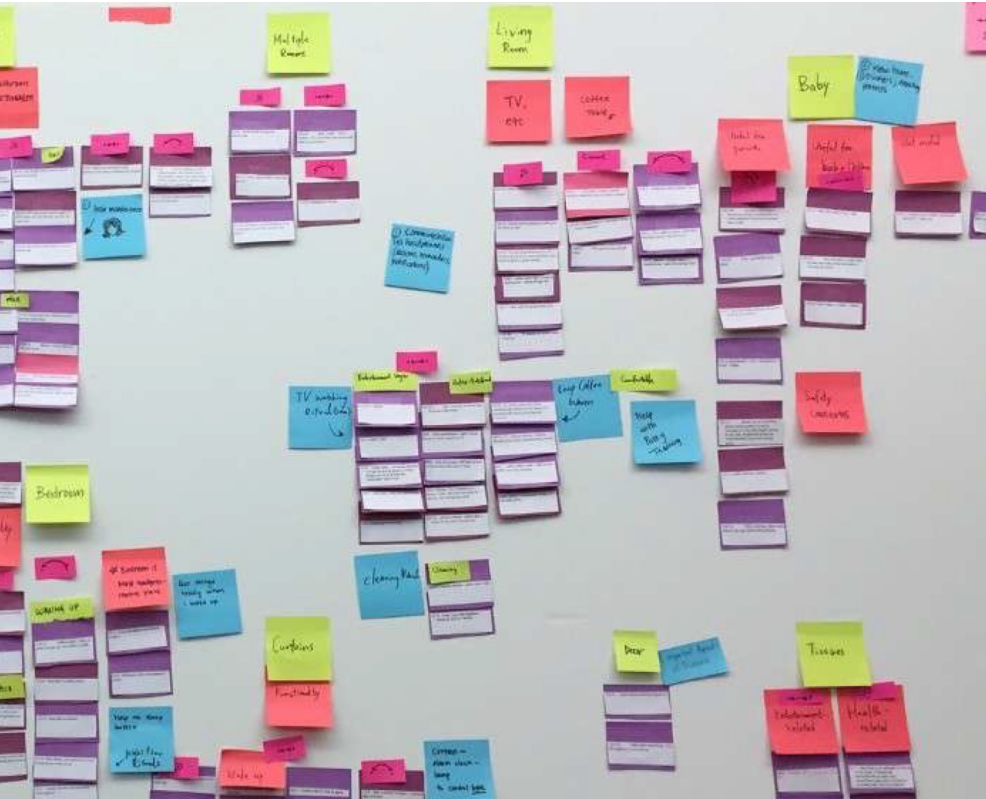
Why does person X needs to do Y?

What makes doing Y difficult or desirable?

How do we enable person X to do Y?



A vision impaired person (X) needs to cross the road easily and safely  
without needing any help (Y)



# HOW do we represent?

- user profiles
- personas
- scenarios
- affinity diagrams
- journey maps
- site maps etc.

Image: Weprin, M (2016) Design Thinking Methods: Affinity Diagrams. UXDICT.IO. Available online: <https://uxdict.io/design-thinking-methods-affinity-diagrams-357bd8671ad4>

# Personas

## Alice Mathews

Persona A

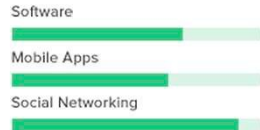


|            |                   |
|------------|-------------------|
| AGE        | 32                |
| OCCUPATION | Business Analyst  |
| STATUS     | Single            |
| LOCATION   | USA, California   |
| SCHEDULE   | Have limited time |
| ARCHETYPE  | Business Woman    |

### PERSONALITY



### TECHNOLOGY



### ABOUT

Alice is a business analyst in a huge company. On her age of 25, she moved to California from Florida. Most of her family and old friends lives far away from her, so she can not congratulate them every time, in personal, when they have a special occasion. She orders often gifts from the internet and send greeting cards to her friends and colleagues. She is a confident web and app user, but due to her busy schedule, she likes when she can quick and easy use an online service.

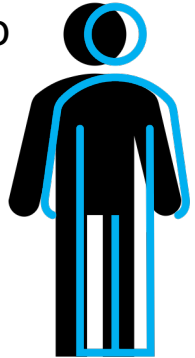
### GOALS

- To create and send fast a greeting card;
- Make a nice and valuable gift;
- More automated process;

# Personas

- A similarly behaving group of people can be represented as a persona.
- The shared goals, motivations and frustrations of the group are used for characterisation of the persona.

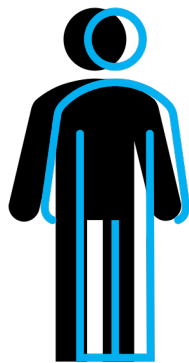
(Goodwin, 2009)



# Personas

- Evoke the people designers are designing for
- Composites of real people NOT a singular person
- Narrative description of a user's characteristics, background, motivations, goals and needs
- Based on user research or user profiles
- Vivid and engaging for the design team
- Keep the users in focus during the design process.

(Goodwin, 2009)



# Personas are not ...

- a copy of a person you have interviewed
- a single user who you think is most representative
- an average of all the people you have interviewed
- a stereotype ie. a widely held, but oversimplified idea, of a particular type of person.



Personas are distinct and believable, they emerge from patterns in the data, and with a big data set there will be many personas

## Alice Mathews

Persona A



### PERSONALITY



### ABOUT

Alice is a business analyst in a huge company. On her age of 25, she moved to California from Florida. Most of her family and old friends lives far away from her, so she can not congratulate them every time, in personal, when they have a special occasion. She orders often gifts from the internet and send greeting cards to her friends and colleagues. She is a confident web and app user, but due to her busy schedule, she likes when she can quick and easy use an online service.

### GOALS

- To create and send fast a greeting card;
- Make a nice and valuable gift;
- More automated process;

AGE 32  
OCCUPATION Business Analyst  
STATUS Single  
LOCATION USA, California  
SCHEDULE Have limited time  
ARCHETYPE Business Woman

Behance, 2020

## Leo Chung --- User Persona



"I want to make my family and proud, and show people what I can do."

Age 26  
Tier International student  
Status Single  
Location London, UK  
Archetype Quiet striver

Reserved Diligent  
Optimistic Sensitive

### Bio

Leo is a master student who quit his job 2 years ago to prep for application. Although relatively successful, Leo was not happy with his last job and wanted to switch field after his study. Leo has a very supportive family who used their life insurance's money to financially support his study. Studying abroad is a life-changing experience for him and his family, and he has high hopes and expectations for his time abroad.

### Personality



### Frustrations

- His talents are dismissed because of his accent and language barrier.
- His visa does not give him time to look for work after graduation.
- not receiving the same level of respect or service that he was hoping for.

### Hopes

- To get one or two years of working experience in host country.
- To start his own business in his native country.
- To have a more international perspective and be more respected.

### Motivations



Image: Leslie Shaw, 2020

## LARA TRAVIS

Age 32  
Occupation Businesswoman  
Location Edmonton, AB Canada  
Archetype Philanthropist

### Motivations

"I bring back to life old classic furnitures, they are a piece of art and I consider them my canvas."



### Personality

Creative Confident  
Extrovert Bold

### Technology



### Bio

Lara Travis, 32 yrs old, mother of 2 young kids. She has a very hectic schedule everyday juggling responsibilities between home and her business. Laura owns a classic furniture refurbishing store located 50 minutes away from her home. Her business involves buying old and used furnitures preferably with character and restores or refurbishes and sells them in her store. She depends on kijiji for good bargains preferably direct from owners.

### Goals

She wants to find good bargains on used classic furnitures and be able to find several comparisons before purchasing.

### Pain Points

It always takes her a long time to search for used furnitures online. She goes through long lists and several search steps. Most of the time her search does not take her right away to what she wants to see.

Delgordon, 2020

## Clark Andrews

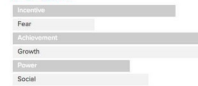
AGE 26  
OCCUPATION Software Developer  
STATUS Single  
LOCATION San Jose, CA  
TIER Experiment Hacker  
ARCHETYPE The Computer Nerd

Friendly Clever Go-Getter



"I feel like there's a smarter way for me to sensation into a healthier lifestyle."

### Motivations



### Goals

- To cut down on unhealthy eating and drinking habits
- To measure multiple aspects of life more scientifically
- To set goals and see and make positive impacts on his life

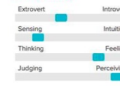
### Frustrations

- Unfamiliar with wearable technology
- Saturated tracking market
- Manual tracking is too time consuming

### Bio

Aaron is a systems software developer, a "data junkie" and for the past couple years, has been very interested in tracking aspects of his health and performance. Aaron wants to track his mood, happiness, sleep quality and how his eating and exercise habits affects his well being. Although he only drinks occasionally with friends on the weekend, he would like to cut down on alcohol intake.

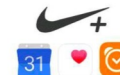
### Personality



### Technology



### Brands



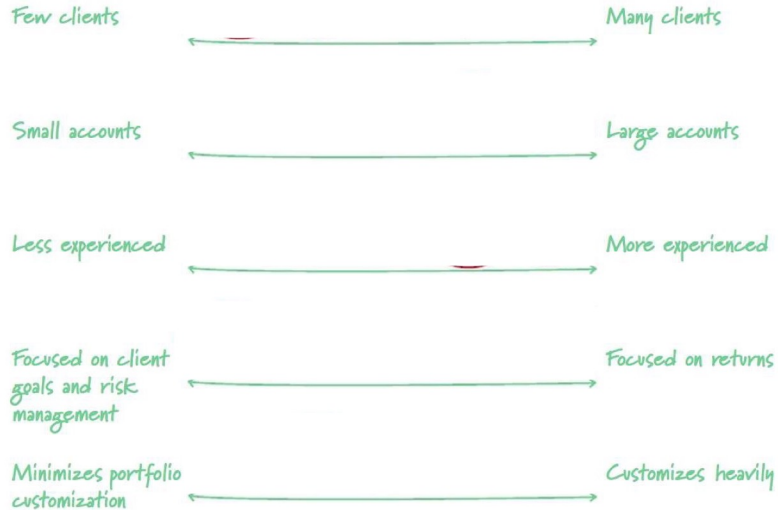
Pinterest, 2020

# Creating personas

1. Compare one particular group of interviewees at a time
2. Identify behavioural variables eg. goals, task frequency
3. Identify demographic variables eg. international or domestic
4. Map the interviews against the variables
5. Group interviewees based on similarities
6. Identify and explain potential patterns

(Goodwin, 2009)

# Identify the patterns in the data



## Similarly behaving groups can be represented as a persona



## Explain the patterns in the data

- Look for people that cluster together across multiple variables
- Formulate explanations for the clustering
- Is there a plausible explanation for the relationship between variables?
- Keep looking for more patterns until the data is exhausted

(Goodwin, 2009)

## Similarly behaving groups can be represented as a persona



# Creating personas *cont.*

7. Turn each behaviour pattern into a persona by articulating goals
  - i. End goals: What people want to achieve from using the product/service
  - ii. Experience goals: What people want to feel while using the product/service
8. Clarify distinctions and add detail
9. Develop the narrative and other communication tools

(Goodwin, 2009)

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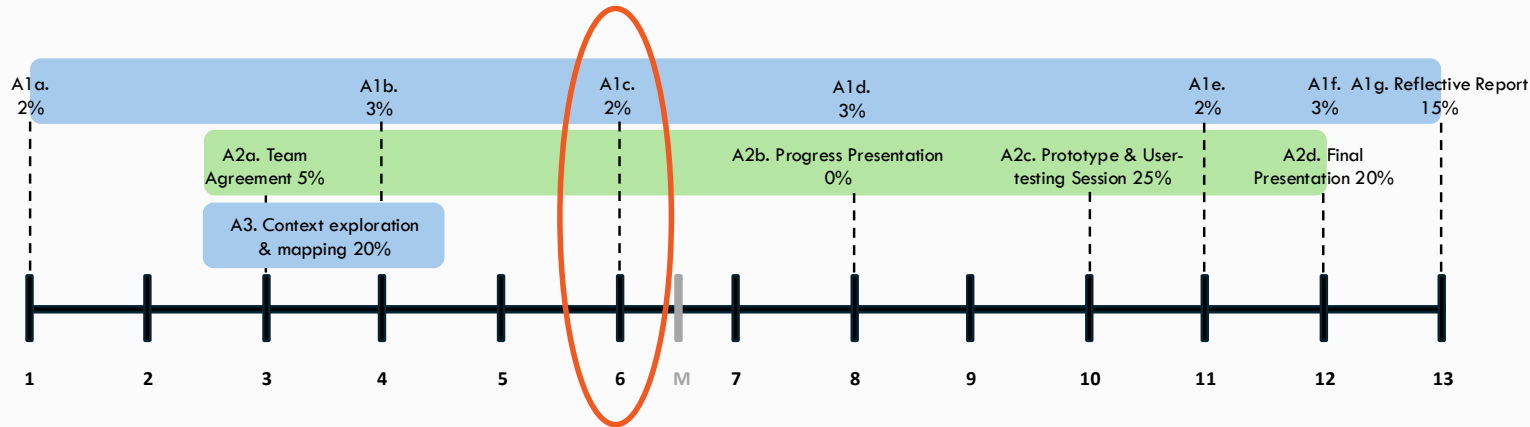


## IDEA9106 Assessments Semester 1 2026

All assessments are mandatory

Questionati is the unit's AI for 24/7 answers to assessment questions

Assessments in this unit are connected, building towards A1g. And A2d.



MS: Mindset

PE: Peer & Self evaluation

Individual tasks

Teamwork tasks

A1: Reflective practice

A2: Collaborative learning

A3: Framing and Reframing

## Hot tips to move from uncertainty to clarity

|                                        |                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Do weekly prework                      | Read through the weekly module, read the readings and attend or listen to the lectures<br>Lectures provide the WHAT, WHY and WHEN for Design Thinking |
| Stay on track with tutorial activities | Complete tutorial activities before the next tutorial to stay on track with the semester long project                                                 |
| Ask questions during tutorials         | Everyone can benefit from hearing the tutor's answer                                                                                                  |
| Ask Questionati about assessments      | Questionati is trained on the unit's assessments and has the answers! See the Homepage link                                                           |
| Use AI appropriately & ethically       | If AI does all the work, you are learning how to prompt but not how to be a Design Thinker. See the AI in Assessment Canvas site                      |

# Reminders

- A1b. self and peer evaluation ratings and feedback is located in the Week 5 module on Canvas
- Conduct more interviews if you want to build the data set for the project group, after conducting affinity diagraming
- Meeting weekly with your project group members to discuss data analysis and reframing of the design brief.
- I will be outside after the lecture for 1:1 consultations

That's the end of today's lecture.

We'll see you in tutorials.

Find your class location here:



THE UNIVERSITY OF  
SYDNEY

